

## 7.2 Fun With Compositing

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The Alpha channel in Photoshop

Compositing is the art of combining videos and images—much like we do in programs like Photoshop—to create effects in digital video. This can range from simple watermarking to the “invisible man” effects we all love so much. If you’re familiar with Alpha channels in images, you can also use them to hide or show parts of the image in your composition.

Getting an image with an Alpha channel into your video is as easy as can be. First, start Photoshop (or whichever image editing program you use, as long as it supports alpha channels), and add a new channel from the Channels palette. The channel is usually black by default, representing total transparency. Paint white over areas that you want to be visible. You can even use different levels of gray for semi-transparent areas. Import this into Wax,